

Moles, hedgehogs, and shrews

These mammals all have sharp teeth, small eyes, and a keen sense of smell. Most feed on insects and earthworms, although hedgehogs are omnivorous.



Moles have short, velvety fur and live in tunnels they dig with shovel-like front paws.



Hedgehogs forage at night. If attacked, they roll into a ball to use their spines as protection.

Bats

With wings made of skin, bats are the only flying mammals. Small kinds usually feed on insects, while large ones feed mainly at flowers and on fruit.



Fruit bats have large eyes and most roost in trees. Their wings span up to 6 ft (1.8 m).



Vampire bats have good eyesight and sharp teeth and feed on mammal and bird blood.

Carnivores

Closely related to one another, many meat-eating mammals form a group called the carnivores. These include the world's biggest land predators. Carnivores' teeth are the right shapes for gripping and slicing meat. Most are fast and agile, with forward-facing eyes, claws, and a keen sense of hearing and smell. Some carnivores eat nothing but meat, but others have mixed diets. The giant panda feeds almost entirely on one plant—bamboo.

The tiger is the largest member of the cat family. Once widespread in Asia, it is now critically endangered.



Many mongooses live in burrows that were dug by other animals. They often mark their new territory, and their young, with scent.



Many members of the dog family, such as wolves, are pack-forming predators that use speed and endurance to catch prey.



Brown bears are the largest land predators. Those that eat mainly meat grow to twice the weight of those that eat mainly plants.



Badgers often live in social groups in large, underground burrows, or setts, and come out at night to find food.



Harp seals are born on ice. Many spend their lives cruising the chilly waters of the Arctic Ocean feeding on fish and crustaceans.